

DEAR MAN — Interpersonal Effectiveness

Greater Nashua Mental Health Center

Instructions: DEAR MAN is a DBT interpersonal-effectiveness skill for asking for something or saying no while keeping your self-respect and the relationship. Plan your script below before a difficult conversation.

Situation / what I want to ask for or decline:

DEAR — What you say

D — Describe the facts (no judgment)

E — Express your feelings and opinions (use 'I' statements)

A — Assert your ask clearly (ask for what you want or say no plainly)

R — Reinforce (explain the positive effect of getting what you ask for)

MAN — How you say it

- Mindful — stay focused on your goal; use the 'broken record' and ignore attacks.
- Appear confident — eye contact, steady voice, upright posture; no whispering or hedging.
- Negotiate — be willing to give to get; offer alternatives and ask for other solutions.

My fallback / what I'm willing to negotiate: